The Finish Line Kit

How to turn a new spark into something finished, without burning your life down every eighty seconds.

For the brain that is brilliant at starting and has a drawer of beautiful beginnings.

Starting is easy. The middle is the problem.

A new idea gives you a spike of energy. A process gives you a list of steps. The trouble lives in the handover between the two.

Most of us do the fantasy brilliantly: the mood board, the name, the version of life where it all works. Then it turns into a process, step by step, and it can feel dead on arrival. That is not a flaw in you. Finishing asks for a kind of regulation that most of us were never taught, so we stop expecting ourselves to do it alone.

The usual loop

Spark, big plan, buy things, first wobble, quiet guilt, new spark. The loop repeats because nothing catches the idea at the wobble.

The loop with a catcher

Spark, park it, shrink it, one small step, a done marker, then decide. AI does the catching, so you only have to do the next step.

This kit gives you five small moves in order. Use one tonight and the rest when you need them.

Rule of the kit: an idea does not need a decision today. It needs a place to wait.

Park the spark, do not feed it.

When a new life shows up at ten at night, the goal is not to kill it. The goal is to give it a seat and a date.

1 **Say it out loud to an AI for sixty seconds.** The kiln, the move, the new studio. Include the exciting ending; it is part of the idea.

2 **Have it write the idea on one card.** What it is, why it is exciting, what you imagine at the end, and the one thing that would prove it is real.

3 **Do not buy, book or announce anything.** Nothing leaves the card for seven days. If it still pulls after a week, it has earned a trial.

PASTE THIS

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I have a new idea and I am excited. I will ramble about it. Do not
hype it and do not talk me out of it. Write it as a card with four
lines: the idea in one sentence, why it excites me, the ending I am
picturing, and the one cheap thing I could do in 30 minutes to test
if it is real. Then give me a date seven days from today to review
it. Do not suggest buying anything.
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Why it works: your excitement is real, so it gets honoured. It just gets a waiting room instead of a three-year business plan.

Shrink it to a thirty-minute trial.

A trial is not a commitment. It is a small, cheap, time-boxed experiment with a clear end, so the answer to "could this be the life that fits me" comes from evidence, not mood boards.

01 SIZE	**Thirty minutes, under thirty pounds.** One class, one video series, one borrowed tool. If it needs more than that to try, it is not a trial yet.
02 BORING PART	**Do the dull middle on purpose.** Pick the least glamorous step, like measuring, sorting or practising scales. That is the part that tells you the truth.
03 QUESTION	**Decide the question before you start.** For example: do I still want this when it is tedious? Write it down so the answer is not rewritten by the mood.
04 RESULT	**Score it straight after.** Ask yourself, and the AI, for a verdict in one line: carry on, park again, or let it go with thanks.

PASTE THIS

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Here is my idea card: [paste]. Design a trial for it that takes no
more than 30 minutes and costs under 30 pounds. Pick the dullest real
step, not the fun one. Write the single question the trial must
answer, and three signs that the answer is yes. Keep it to six lines.
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When it starts to feel dead, hand it over.

The wobble arrives when the idea turns into steps. That is the moment to stop leaning on interest and start leaning on structure.

Signs you are at the wobble

You keep opening the project and closing it. You start researching a better version instead. You feel the pull of a brand new idea.

What to do instead

Do not push harder. Ask for the next step to be made so small that it needs no decision, then do only that.

THE WOBBLE PROMPT

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I am in the middle of [project] and it has started to feel dull. Do not motivate me. Ask me two quick questions about where I am stuck, then give me one next step that takes ten minutes or less and needs no decision. Start the sentence with a verb. When I say done, give me the next one. Stop after three and tell me what I finished.
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THE DONE MARKER

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Keep a running list called Finished for this project. Every time I say done, add the step and today's date. When I ask, read me the list so I can see how far I have come.
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A finished list matters more than a to-do list. It is the evidence your brain refuses to remember on its own.

Choose your rabbit holes carefully.

Hyperfocus is a gift when you know the process and know there may be a come down. Choose it, rather than falling into it.

1. **Run the three-question check.** Do I still want this when it is tedious? Do I have room for it this month? What would I let go of to make space?

2. **Name the come down in advance.** Write one line: "If I feel the crash on day six, I will take the smallest next step and keep the card."

3. **Keep one thing in the finishing lane at a time.** Everything else stays parked on a card. Parked is not failed.

THE WEEKLY REVIEW

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Here are my idea cards and my Finished list: [paste]. Tell me which
one ran the trial and still pulls, which two I should leave parked,
and which one I should let go of with thanks. Give one sentence of
reasoning each. Then name the one thing I should finish this week.
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Tonight

1. **Make a card for the loudest idea** with the Page 2 prompt, then book its seven-day review.

Not medical advice. This is a working method that sits alongside whatever support you already use. Change the words until they sound like you.

You are not collecting hobbies. You are testing possible lives, so test them one at a time.